Plant diseases

Like animals, plants also suffer from disease. **Fungal** diseases such as mildew and brown rot are common in vegetable and fruit crops. The fungus spreads from plant to plant through tiny fungal spores which float in the air. The spores thrive in warm, moist conditions. **Bacterial** diseases such as bacterial blight are also airborne and thrive in **humid** crowded conditions, such as among potted glasshouse plants. Plant diseases are also spread by insects. Bunchy top is a serious **viral** disease affecting bananas. It is spread by banana **aphids**, which carry the disease from plant to plant.

☞ **1** The three types of plant pathogens are:

_____ _____ _____

2 Humid means:

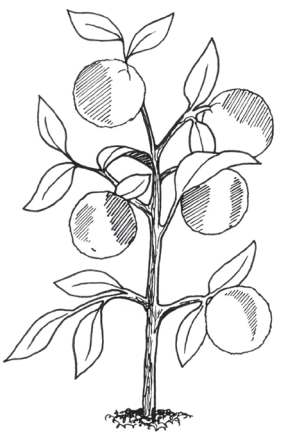
a) cold and wet **b)** warm and wet **c)** warm and dry **d)** cold and dry

3 Should potted plants be packed together tightly in a greenhouse?
Why or why not? _____

4 Use the information in the text above to complete the following table. Draw lines to join each plant illustration to the disease that affects it.

	Brown rot	Bunchy top	Bacterial blight
Pathogen (organism that produces the disease)			
Example of affected species			
How disease is spread			







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ISBN 978 1 92571 041 0